

2038

TYCOONS OF THE ASTEROID BELT

EXPANSION SET

1. INTRODUCTION

This **2038 Expansion Set** introduces two new Corporations, which can simply be added to the existing game, and a Variant Start Packet which can also be used with them. 48 additional ore counters, one rule change and several rules clarifications (based on customer questions since *2038* was published) are also supplied.

2. ADDING THE NEW CORPORATIONS

To add the new Corporations, *On-Site Refining* and *Mining Robotics*, to the full game (but not the Short Game), treat them as group “C” Corporations (available when RCC and OPC become available) and modify setup as follows:

- Add one Phase III, one Phase V and three Phase VI spaceships.
- Use the following procedure to place the bases for these Corporations. Both of these bases start the game in play.

Randomly draw two asteroid tiles and place them as shown. Put the *On-Site Refining* START base on the BASE section and the +10 / RARE counter on the REFUEL SLOT of the tile located near *Drill Hound's* starting hex. Place the *Mining Robotics* START base on the BASE section and the NO BONUS counter on the REFUEL SLOT of the tile located near *Ice Finder's* starting hex.

(Or use the pre-printed OSR & MR base hexes provided in this print & play kit.)

The Certificate Limit is increased (see chart). *Mars Mining* gains 2 more Claims. Upgrading to Phase VI spaceships may only occur after **two** of the Phase V ships have been purchased (not one). All other rules remain the same.

Refueling Stations may **not** be placed at either of these two starting bases. *On-Site Refining's* and *Mining Robotics's* claim costs are exceptions to rules 7.43 and 7.45. *On-Site Refining* extracts ore with a higher yield per volume. This is reflected in its \$10 bonus per claim and higher costs. Its parent company uses these techniques to profitably further refine Rare ore before shipping it; thus, its +\$10 / RARE home base delivery bonus. *Mining Robotics* uses intelligent robots to a greater degree than the other companies, allowing it to develop mines cheaper and faster than its competitors. This is reflected in its \$40 claim cost, even if it develops two claims in a single turn.

3. VARIANT START PACKET

Setup. Substitute the certificates provided with this expansion for the six Private Company certificates (COs #0 and #7-11). (Note that Private COs #7-9 no longer come with a TSI share apiece.) Add the two Corporations, spaceships and two extra *Mars Mining* Claims as described above, **plus** add:

- \$300 to the total start money divided by the number of players (see chart).
- Two more Phase I spaceships.

Play proceeds normally with the exceptions noted above and the following:

- *TSI's* par price is no longer predetermined (either \$100 or \$67 varying with the Full or Short game) but is set by the *TSI* President as soon as Private Co. #10, the *Space Transportation Co.*, is purchased. *TSI* is still always a Public Corporation.

Note that after all Private and Independent Companies have been purchased, *TSI* will not operate until three more *TSI* shares have been bought.

- Use the optional rule **Stock Repurchases by Corporations** (see box at right).

Note that the wording at right has been slightly revised for clarity and is now official.

- Once all twelve Private and Independent Companies have been purchased, **all** Corporations (except the *Asteroid League*) are **available** to be launched. Ignore the ‘A’, ‘B’ and ‘C’ Corporation grouping.

Growth Corporations may still not be launched during Phase I.

Comments: The total base cost of the ‘start packet’ has been reduced from \$1430 to \$1075. With the extra \$300, this leaves \$1025 to be spend on bidding items up and launching Corporations, which often results in two Corporations being launched.

Due to the Probe, Private Co. #10, the *Space Exploration Co.*, offers a decent return in Phase I, even if *TSI* isn’t launched immediately. However, once Phase II begins – and the Probe becomes obsolete – its return is much less favorable. Ensuring that *TSI* operates by then, by having 50% of its shares sold, is important to its owner.

Components Version 2 (22-Apr-2013)

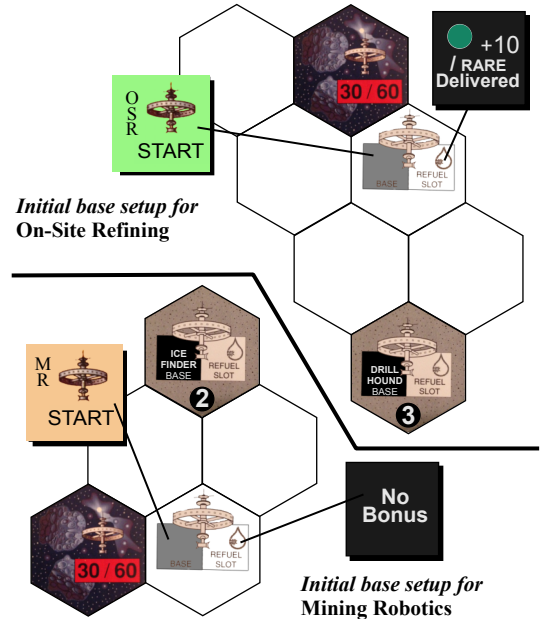
A complete 2038 Expansion Set includes:

- 2 Corporation mats
- 31 Share, Spaceship and Co. Certificates
- 92 counters (*plus 2 optional hexes*)
- 2-page rules sheet (what you’re reading)

Recreated with permission from Tom Lehmann

- Ron Krantz

RaDiKal on Boardgamegeek.com



Certificate Limit / Variant Starting Money

# of Players	Full Game	w/ 10 Corps.	Money
3	22	27	\$700
4	16	20	525
5	13	16	420
6	11	13	350

Stock Repurchases by Corporations.

Modify the following rules:

5.3 All shares in the **Growth** Corporation share box (only) are bought at the **higher** of that Corporation’s par or current stock value, placing the amount paid into that Corporation’s treasury.

7.2 A Corporation receives paid (or partially paid) earnings **only** for stock shares in the Growth Corporation box or *Asteroid League* trade-in box. It does **not** receive earnings for any shares in the **Stock Market**.

7.4 A Corporation (even a Public one) may, before and/or after step 2 of the operating sequence and using only its own funds, buy one or more of its shares from the Stock Market at the current stock price, placing them in the **Growth** Corporation box.

CREDITS

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Rules Clarifications

Change: Once the *Asteroid League* forms (but has not yet acquired a spaceship), the *Asteroid Export Company's* certificate no longer counts towards its owner's certificate limit (but the newly received *Asteroid League* President's share does).

Previously, the *Asteroid League's* formation would occasionally result in a player exceeding the certificate limit (particularly in the Short Game) and having to sell a share just prior to losing the *Asteroid Export Co.'s* certificate in the next Operating Round.

Clarification: The initial auction is part of the first stock round (and as many stock rounds as it takes for all Private and Independent Companies to be sold). If all players pass before the initial auction is finished, that stock round is over and two operating rounds then occur before resuming the initial auction in the second stock round (and so on). Once all twelve Companies have been sold, the initial auction is over but that stock round continues until all players consecutively pass.

Clarification: A Growth Corporation does **not** receive \$134 from the bank when launched; it instead receives the treasury amount (if any) of the Independent from which it was formed. It receives additional capital only as its 10% shares are purchased from the Growth Box.

Clarification: Ore bonuses due to bases ("per ore delivered") and Independents, Pilots and Corporations ("per ore delivery") operate in exactly the same manner despite their slightly different wordings (i.e. each and every ore pickup of the indicated type delivered by an Independent/Pilot/Corporation receives any listed ore bonus even when several of the same type of ore are being delivered together).

Clarification: A Corporation buying a mandatory spaceship which can afford, of the current phase ships, a (cheaper) SCOUT may **not** use its President's personal funds to buy a (more expensive) TUG. However, a Corporation which cannot afford **either** of the two ship types currently available (and therefore must use its President's personal funds) **may** choose to buy the more expensive TUG, even if doing so results in its President having to sell (possibly additional) shares of stock.

Clarification: Refueling stations are placed **after** bases in the Corporation operating sequence. Thus, a refueling station will not extend a Corporation's range for placing a base in the round that the refueling station is placed. An exception is the refueling station placed by exercising Company #8's special property. Since special properties are exercised **before** bases are placed, this refueling station will extend a Corporation's range for placing a base later in that same round. This is an intended feature of Company #8's special property (just as #7's free base placement ignores range and #9's free claim is in addition to any other claims placed that round by its owning Corporation).

Clarification: Upgrading a spaceship to a Phase VI ship **is** a purchase. Thus, upgrading a Phase III spaceship immediately advances the game to Phase VI (removing all other Phase III spaceships from the game).

Design Afterthoughts

In general, I am quite happy with *2038* and its reception. It has gained popularity among 18xx players as possibly the 18xx game with the most emphasis on route construction. Its most significant design departure — its random element — has been accepted as intended, as a way of making each game feel fresh and preventing stylized route development. *2038* has gained popularity among many non-train gamers, introducing the 18xx system to them.

There have been three major criticisms of *2038*. First, it is a long game. I don't believe there is much that can be done here beyond emphasizing that the Short Game exists and that it does pose some challenging decisions. Providing interesting route development by offering a lot of options lengthens the game. Second, some players have felt *2038* could benefit from a couple more Corporations to provide additional mid-game investment options. This is valid — which is why they've been provided here — though adding them does slightly lengthen the game. Third, some players have felt that the financial side of the game is overly rigid and that, in particular, *TSI* is too powerful. This touches on a deep design issue.

Actual financial investors can invest in several alternatives (bonds, stocks, commodities, etc.) and have to weigh off relative rates of return. In many 18xx games, this sense of an 'opportunity cost' is lost. Starting a Corporation is a 'good thing' due to leverage (the ability to pay double for Private COs in most 18xx games) and, with rapid train (spaceship) purchases, the short midgame reduces the value of being an 'established' company. The only real catch is making sure you don't end up with a long-term train liability.

Putting an opportunity cost into the 18xx system is hard. Consider the *1829* steam packets; if they paid more than Corporation shares, the game would be stupid; you would just buy steam packets and say the heck with this train stuff. If they pay worse (as they do), they just become a place to put excess cash (with some bad 'rich gets richer' game properties). Picking the right percentage for them to pay so that they serve as a true opportunity cost is virtually impossible since the game itself can develop in so many ways.

The approach used in *2038* was to give one Corporation a special position and spread its shares among the players. *TSI* is the 'rabbit' that jumps out of the gate and sets the pace for the investors and other Corporations to react to. We didn't pull our punches. *TSI* isn't guaranteed to fade in the stretch; players have to work to make sure that their overall portfolio beats the *TSI* President's portfolio (who has to do more than just be its President to win). We think we got this balance right; most players agree (though possibly the optional stock repurchasing rule should have been in the standard rules). The variant start packet provides an alternative; *TSI* is no longer a sure thing (it may not even be active) and the order in which Corporations are launched is much more flexible. Enjoy.

Private Company (Variant Start Pack) and Corporation Summary

#	Private Co.	Bid	Income	Shares	Sell to Corp?	Notes
0	Planetary Imports	\$ 35	\$ 10	—	yes	—
7	Tunnel Systems	20	5	—	yes	Corp. may place 1 free Base on any explored and unclaimed tile.
8	Vacuum Associates	40	10	—	yes	Corp may place 1 free Refueling Station within range.
9	Robot Smelters	60	15	—	yes	Corp. may place 1 free Claim within range.
10	Space Exploration Co.	160	20	TSI Pres.	no	Flies Probe if <i>TSI</i> is inactive. Remove cert. after <i>TSI</i> buys a ship.
11	Asteroid Export Co.	160	30	(A.L. Pres.)	no	May (must) start <i>Asteroid League</i> in Phase III (IV). Remove this certificate after the <i>Asteroid League</i> acquires a spaceship.

Gp	Corporation	Delivery Bonus	Bases	Refuel	Claims	Notes
—	Trans-Space, Inc.	—	1	3	10	Receives Probe as one of its four initially allowed spaceships.
A	Resources Unlimited	—	1	1	12	Places its first claim each round for free (second one costs \$100).
B	Lunar Enterprises	\$ 10 / Nickel	1	2	9	—
B	Mars Mining Associates	10 / Ice	3	3	8	Each of its bases costs \$25 to place.
B	Venus Prospectors, Ltd.	10 / Rare	3	4	5	Each of its refueling stations costs \$25 to place.
C	Outer Planet Consortium	10 / Nickel	2	3	7	Places its first refueling station per game for free (rest cost \$50).
C	Ring Construction Corp.	10 / Nickel	2	2	8	—
C	On-Site Refining	10 / all claims	1	1	6	Places its 1st claim / round and buys claims for \$80; 2nd for \$120
C	Mining Robotics	—	2	2	14	Places its first and second claim each round for \$40 apiece.
—	Asteroid League	—	7	4	15	May place 3 claims / round; 2nd claim costs \$75 (3rd costs \$100). Its last spaceship may not be bought. \$250 initial capital.

M R BASE	REFUEL	M R START	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM
Mining Robotics	Mining Robotics	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM
M R BASE	REFUEL	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM	MR CLAIM

M R Co. #7	M R Co. #8	M R GROWTH	M R Co. #9
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MM CLAIM	V
MM CLAIM	V

OSR BASE (NO REFUEL SLOT) +10 / RARE Delivered	MR BASE (NO REFUEL SLOT) No Bonus
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O S BASE	OSR CLAIM	REFUEL	O S START	OSR CLAIM	OSR CLAIM
O-S R	O-S R	OSR CLAIM	OSR CLAIM	OSR CLAIM	OSR CLAIM

O S Co. #7	O S Co. #9	O S Co. #8	O S GROWTH
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No Bonus +10 / RARE Delivered

T	T	T	T	N	N	N	N
60	60	70	70	50	50	50	50
N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N
60	60	60	60	60	60	60	60
I	I	I	I	I	I	N	N
60	40	40	40	40	40	60	60
I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I
60	60	60	60	50	50	50	50
R	R	R	R	R	R	I	I
60	60	50	50	50	50	50	50
R	R	R	R	R	R	R	R
60	60	60	70	70	70	70	70

Readme

Notes on assembling the expansion set

1. Print the first two pages back to back
(forms the 2-page expansion rules)
2. Print the third page (this page), mount to cardboard and cut out (to form the counters)
3. Print the fourth, fifth and sixth pages to cardstock
(forms the charters, shares and ships)
 - a. Note that the Phase I, III and V class ships are two-sided. DO NOT cut along the dotted lines; instead, fold along the dotted lines and glue the front and back together.

All charters, stock certificates and ships have an "Expansion & Variant" label and the two additional 'MM' counters have a 'V' to make it easy to separate out the Expansion and Variant components.

- Ron

O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%
O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%
O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R On-Site Refining Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	O-S R O-S R On-Site Refining President Expansion & Variant 2 Shares20%

On-Site Refining +10 / all delivered Claims. Claims cost +\$20; those bought from Independent COs cost \$80, \$20 of which is paid to the bank. Base Refueling Station Claims 1 1 6 \$50 \$50 \$80 / \$120 O-S R	Private Companies / Pilot	Treasury:
Spaceships: May own 4 spaceships in Phases I-II; 3 in Phases III-V; and 2 in Phase VI.		Expansion & Variant

Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%
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Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Expansion & Variant 1 Share10%	Mining Robotics Mining Robotics Mining Robotics President Expansion & Variant 2 Shares20%

Mining Robotics

Both the first and second claim placed in a round each cost \$40.

Mining Robotics

Bases

2

\$50

Refueling Stations

2

\$50

Claims

14

\$40 / \$40

Private Companies / Pilot

Treasury:

Spaceships: May own 4 spaceships in Phases I-II; 3 in Phases III-V; and 2 in Phase VI.

Expansion & Variant

